STATE SCAN

UP: TRIANGLE WITH A SIDE PAIN PG 18 | J&K: HEAVEN'S PREMIER LEAGUE VANISHES PG 20



'Bhubaneswar 2.0' plan by MoHUA and an enhanced image of the model (above)



▶ ODISHA

BHUBANESWAR 2.0

If it happens, the 'New City' could be a template for our urban sprawls

By **Arkamoy Datta Majumdar**

IN TALK OF INDIA'S MODERN URBAN PLANNING, most of the fawning is reserved for Corbusier's city. But Chandigarh was still only an idea without a body when modern Bhubaneswar came up. In 1948, Odisha's capital had already shifted to German architect Otto Königsberger's wide-avenued city, dotted with gardens and parks. But nearly eight decades of haphazard growth have wrought the usual havoc. And so, there is to be a Bhubaneswar 2.0, or 'The New City', on the outskirts of the old one, a project that may become a model for the rest of India. If one goes by the official version, that is, ignoring the discordant voices.

So, what does the formal blueprint have? The basic idea is kosher enough. Coming up over 324 hectares will be not just buildings and roads. The recipe aims to create the right kind of 'smart' blend—innovation, ecology and inclusivity. A balance of nature and modernity: 182.05 ha developable land, flanked by a 48.18 ha restricted development zone and 92.30 ha reserved forest. Picture a "people's street" with pop-up cafés, a central green vista, cyclists gliding through shaded lanes, pathways overlooking the forest edge. Post-modern human bustle in sync with ecological calm.

A primary innovation node is to host MICE (Meetings, Incentives, Conferences, Exhibitions) facilities, IT campuses and research hubs. A secondary node will have residences, retail and leisure zones. And a green hub will offer eco-resorts, staycations and forest trails. Nearly 47 per cent of